3R MODEL · Human Capital Digest
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Ukraine faces a compounding human capital crisis: 57% of refugees abroad are employed but remain 22 points behind host-country nationals, veterans need structured reintegration, and domestic education systems show resilience under strain. Coordinated action across return, recruitment, and retention is critical to reversing demographic and skills losses.

> Skills mismatch among Ukrainian refugees in host countries represents a double loss — talent underutilized abroad and unavailable for reconstruction at home.

RETURN

Ukrainian Families as Owners in Reconstruction

Kyiv Post opinion argues Ukrainian families must engage in reconstruction as owners, investors, and strategic partners rather than passive recipients of aid, implying diaspora activation is key to sustainable return.

3R: Frames diaspora reactivation as an ownership model, not charity. Actionable for return-incentive program design.

KYIV POST

Ukraine TPS Extension to October 2026 (US)

USCIS extended Ukraine's Temporary Protected Status to October 19, 2026. While this provides legal stability for Ukrainians in the US, it also delays the urgency of return decisions for a significant diaspora segment.

3R: TPS extension reduces short-term return pressure; Ukraine should use this window to build compelling return incentives proactively.

GLOBAL IMMIGRATION BLOG

Veteran Reintegration as Return Anchor

VoxUkraine analyzes government programs addressing military service consequences and aiding civilian life transitions. Effective veteran reintegration signals societal readiness and can anchor broader community return.

3R: Veterans are a visible test case for Ukraine's reintegration capacity. Success stories attract diaspora confidence to return.

VOXUKRAINE

RECRUIT

Skills Mismatch Traps Ukrainian Refugees in Low-Skill Jobs

OECD finds early employment of Ukrainian refugees concentrated in low-skilled roles despite higher qualification levels. This skills mismatch wastes human capital and reduces incentive for talent to return or be redeployed.

3R: Identifies the core recruitment challenge: qualified Ukrainians abroad are deskilling. Ukraine must create pathways to leverage their actual skills domestically.

OECD

UN Recruiting Communication Talent in Kyiv

CARE Ukraine and UN Volunteer programs are actively recruiting communication coordinators and assistants in Kyiv, signaling that international organizations see active local talent pools worth investing in.

3R: International orgs recruiting locally in Kyiv confirm talent availability. Risk: brain drain into international sector rather than Ukrainian institutions.

FACEBOOK / CARE UKRAINE

IOM Demographic Shifts and Talent Mobility

IOM's World Migration Report 2026 highlights demographic shifts driving global talent needs. Remittances fund education and healthcare, but structural talent gaps in origin countries like Ukraine require active international recruitment partnerships.

3R: Global talent competition intensifies. Ukraine must position itself strategically to attract returning and international specialists.

IOM

RETAIN

Education System Resilience Under War Conditions

CEDOS research documents Ukraine's education system adaptation during war, tracking impacts on housing, schooling continuity, and institutional resilience. Education quality is a primary retention driver for families.

3R: Resilient education systems are critical for retaining families with children. CEDOS data can guide targeted retention policy interventions.

CEDOS

Regional Population Dynamics: IOM Oblast Survey Round 25

IOM's General Population Survey Round 25 (June 2026) provides oblast-level data on population movements, displacement, and settlement patterns, essential for targeting retention interventions geographically.

3R: Oblast-level granularity enables targeted retention policies. Identifies which regions are losing population fastest and need urgent intervention.

IOM DTM

Anti-Trafficking Support as Retention Safeguard

IOM Ukraine supported 107 trafficking survivors (Jan–Sep 2026), many linked to labour exploitation. Protecting vulnerable workers domestically is essential to prevent forced outmigration and maintain trust in Ukraine's labour environment.

3R: Labour exploitation drives involuntary emigration. Strengthening anti-trafficking measures directly supports workforce retention and safety.

IOM UKRAINE

GLOBAL CONTEXT

57% Employment Rate Masks Refugee Integration Gap

UNHCR data shows 57% of Ukrainian refugees in Europe are employed, but they lag 22 percentage points behind host-country nationals. This gap reflects structural barriers and signals difficult full reintegration abroad.

3R: The persistent gap abroad weakens the 'stay abroad' narrative. Ukraine can leverage this frustration to design targeted return packages for semi-integrated refugees.

UNHCR